

Networks Halt
Pool Coverage
Of President

A Response to Trump’s
Exclusion of CNN

By MICHAEL M. GRYNBAUM and ALI WATKINS

The major television networks on Monday suspended their pooled coverage of President Trump, breaking a practice that dates back decades after Mr. Trump refused to allow CNN to serve as a pool representative.

The move was an extraordinary escalation amid a showdown between the Trump administration and the White House press corps, which began last week when the president barred journalists at CNN, MS NOW and Politico from entering the White House grounds. Those three outlets sued on Monday to regain access.

Despite Mr. Trump’s years of lawsuits and threats against the news media, archival news organizations have rarely undertaken this kind of collective action.

Five networks — ABC, CBS, CNN, Fox News and NBC — have long shared the responsibility of providing television coverage of the president, splitting the financial costs and distributing footage that is carried by news outlets worldwide. The networks perform their duties on a rotation, and CNN had been scheduled to provide coverage for Mr. Trump’s travel on Monday to the United Nations General Assembly.

Separately, news organizations including The New York Times and The Washington Post said on Monday that they would not publish any images of the day’s presidential events that were taken as part of the still photography pool system. Charlie Stadlander, a spokesman for The Times, said the move was a “a show of support for the news organizations being unfairly targeted by the president’s barring of journalists from the White House.”

It is extremely unusual for a president to travel or hold public events without being accompanied by representatives from the television pool. The president’s activities on Monday were still

Continued on Page A14



ANGELINA KATSANIS FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

At this week’s United Nations General Assembly, key issues include A.I. guardrails, imperiled alliances and instability caused by war.

Deportation of Trump Ally’s Foe Is Fast-Tracke

This article is by Nicholas Ne-hamas, José María León Cabrera, Hamed Aleaziz and Genevieve Glatsky.

WASHINGTON — A prominent former government official from Ecuador was deported last month in an unusual move by the U.S. immigration authorities, who reversed a ruling that had blocked his removal because he could face torture back home.

The former official, José Serrano, is being held in a maximum-security prison in Ecuador, where he was told that video of him stripped naked would be shared with the Ecuadorean president, Daniel Noboa, according to his lawyers.

Ecuadorean officials have denied that Mr. Serrano — charged with orchestrating the 2023 assassination of a presidential candidate — had been mistreated.

A Removal to Ecuador
Shows Immigration
Courts in Sway

Mr. Noboa, a crucial ally in President Trump’s crackdown on drug trafficking, seemed to take credit on social media for Mr. Serrano’s Aug. 28 deportation almost in real time.

“We said it, we did it,” Mr. Noboa boasted in Spanish on social media just 15 minutes after records show U.S. officials had placed Mr. Serrano on a small charter plane bound for Ecuador. In his post, Mr. Noboa included a photo of Mr. Serrano shackled between two Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents.

A review by The New York Times of Mr. Serrano’s arrest and

deportation underscores how the Trump administration has taken control of the U.S. immigration court system, reshaping it for its own political ends to carry out its hard-line policies.

Mr. Serrano served as interior minister for Ecuador’s former president Rafael Correa, a bitter rival of Mr. Noboa. Mr. Serrano later sought political asylum in the United States. Although he denies that he played a role in the assassination, he admitted taking more than \$500,000 in bribes in an unrelated matter.

ICE agents arrested Mr. Serrano in Miami last year, days after Mr. Noboa privately met with Kristi Noem, then the homeland security secretary, in Ecuador.

The leftist former minister fought deportation from behind bars for months, eventually convincing a U.S. immigration judge

Continued on Page A15

Paramount
Clears a Path
For a Merger

This article is by Benjamin Mullin, David McCabe, Shawn Hubler and Laurel Rosenhall.

Paramount reached an agreement on Monday to resolve an antitrust lawsuit delaying its \$111 billion acquisition of Warner Bros. Discovery, eliminating the last significant barrier to the creation of an entertainment and media colossus.

A group of states, led by California’s attorney general, Rob Bonta, a Democrat, sued Paramount in July, arguing that an acquisition of Warner Bros. Discovery would concentrate too much power over cable television and blockbuster films under one company.

After weeks of on-again-off-again negotiations, Paramount and the states agreed to a number of concessions to complete the deal, Mr. Bonta said at a news conference on Monday. The entertainment giant has agreed to establish a board to ensure the editorial independence of CNN and CBS News and committed to distributing 30 movies in theaters every year. The company also pledged to spend an additional \$1.5 billion on

Continued on Page A17

‘Grand Slam’ or ‘Stupid’: Right Is Split on Aid to At-Home Parents

By CORAL DAVENPORT

WASHINGTON — Republicans are sharply divided over a new plan being drafted by the Trump administration that would allow stay-at-home spouses to collect child care subsidy payments from a federal program intended to assist working parents.

Some commentators and lawmakers called the policy, which could help realize a vision of stay-at-home motherhood championed by Vice President JD Vance, a “grand slam,” “no-brainer” and “President Trump’s greatest legacy.”

Others eviscerated it as “socialism,” “rank politics” and “stupid.”

The split reaction reflects one of the emerging fractures in Mr. Trump’s MAGA coalition. Traditional Republicans, religious conservatives and America First populists have jostled for influence with the pronatalist movement, which aims for women to have more children and stay home to raise them, and supporters of Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.’s Make America Healthy Again movement.

And the role of the federal government in shaping family policy has proved to be a key flashpoint.

When news of the plan broke over Labor Day weekend, Rachel Campos-Duffy, the co-host of “Fox & Friends,” declared on air, “I think this might be my favorite policy, like, ever, that Trump has brought.”



STEPHANIE STRASBURG FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Beccah Williams, a mother who stays at home to raise Madelyn, 4, and Isaiah, 6, in Edon, Ohio.

Ms. Campos-Duffy, the wife of Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy and a mother of nine, is a prominent voice in the pronatalist movement. She and others in the movement said the proposed subsidy would be the administration’s largest step toward achieving pronatalists’ goals.

Conservative podcasts, broad-

casts and social media buzzed with excitement. A coterie of conservative lawmakers, some of whom have tried but failed to push through legislation to pay stay-at-home parents, including Senator Eric Schmitt of Missouri and Representative Anna Paulina Luna of Florida, cheered their support.

But many on the right, even

those who embrace Mr. Vance’s promotion of traditional families, said that handing out government money to parents so they could stay at home would go against core conservative tenets. They also maintained that the proposal contradicted the administration’s efforts to require Americans to

Continued on Page A16

Amazon Workers With 6 Arms
Make Humans Murmur Below

By JULIET MACUR

RICHARDSON, Texas — The sound came out of nowhere.

It began as an unnerving high-pitched hum, like a mosquito flying around a dark room at bedtime, and it grew louder as it drew closer. A family lounging in a backyard pool in Richardson, just north of Dallas, couldn’t help noticing it.

“There’s another one coming this way!” Eric Anderson shouted from his pool float, pointing to an area above a tall line of trees. His 9-year-old daughter, Isla, removed her swim goggles for a clearer look at what could be a scene from science fiction.

Within a minute or so, an 83-pound drone with six blue arms and whirring propellers appeared in a corner of the sky before zipping over nearby houses, looking like a cross between a mechanical dragonfly and an X-wing fighter,



JORDAN VONDERHAAR FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Buzzing delivery drones irritate some neighbors in Texas.

and buzzing like a battalion of bees.

The drone’s mission: delivering an Amazon package.

The single cardboard box of cargo held a maximum of five pounds and was loaded into the drone at Amazon’s distribution

Continued on Page A18



INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Nepal Feels Loss of U.S.A.I.D.

An agency that played a key role after a 2015 earthquake had been dismantled before last month’s flood.

PAGE A7

A Dispute From World War II

Nemuro, Japan, depends on Russia for trade. But it’s also leading a fight to win back islands seized by Moscow.

PAGE A4

NATIONAL A11-21

East Coast Airports Snaled

Tech problems grounded hundreds of flights for hours at several airports, reviving concerns about the aging air traffic control infrastructure.

PAGE A14

Attack Shakes Sikh Community

A crackdown on immigrant commercial vehicle operators preceded the stabbing of a Sikh driver in Wyoming.

PAGE A21

BUSINESS B1-6

A Trade Truce With Thorns

The U.S. and China are engaging in tit-for-tat measures that call into question the stability of their terms.

PAGE B1



SPORTS B7-10

A Belmont Park Makeover

The historic track will have less capacity for horse racing, but it has added space for other activities.

PAGE B7

Revisiting the Glory Days

Some senators are harking to their athletic pasts in debating a college sports regulation bill.

PAGE B10

SCIENCE TIMES D1-8

Plumbing Mouse Brains

Growing human brain tissue inside mice is giving researchers a better look into how complex brain disorders develop, and pointing the way toward more effective treatments.

PAGE D4

A.I.’s Runaway Risk

“Recursive self-improvement” is the idea that artificial intelligence could learn to build and train itself, creating exponential new progress — and a considerable amount of risk.

PAGE D5

OPINION A22-23

The Editorial Board

PAGE A22



ARTS C1-6

A Final Goodbye

A year after the death of Dave Ball, one of the two members of Soft Cell, the duo’s last album is coming out. Above, the other member, Marc Almond.

PAGE C1



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